

Valentin Legras

About myself

As a Senior Data Scientist and Product Owner with 7+ years in regulated clinical data science, my goal is to secure the Principal C&SP Methodology Lead position. I work across clinical and statistical programming workflows using SAS and R, with current hands-on work split about 40% SAS and 60% R. My experience covers CDISC SDTM/ADaM datasets, Pinnacle 21 checks, GxP software practices, regulatory submission support, data anonymisation, and clinical data privacy. I have also led the 'aNCA' open-source R package from concept to enterprise-wide adoption, with 120+ users and more than 2M CHF in annual savings.

My mindset

Strategy and automation entered my life long before I knew the words for them. I was around 10 years old when I started competing in basketball. To perform well against top teams across Europe, individual skill was never enough. It required strategy: analyzing opponents, optimizing plays, and finding the most efficient way to win.

Around the same time, I dived into strategic video games. I was driven to compete in environments where others could pay to get bonuses. To succeed, I had to find the most optimized path, meticulously planning and automating processes to maximize outcomes with limited resources. This wasn't just playing; it was a challenge to reverse-engineer systems, think out of the box, think about how other brains work and find the most efficient solution.

This mindset, which revolves around strategy, optimization, and automation, is a core part of my identity. I have a strong drive to find the most efficient and strategic solution to any problem. In the future, I view AI as a transformative tool that amplifies this drive, enabling me to automate complex processes and uncover optimization opportunities at a scale that wasn't possible before (via multi-agent coding). I don't only build robust and optimized systems in my professional life but also for my personal interests. As an example, I developed back-testing reproducible statistical algorithms to optimize strategies on sports betting websites and investment on S&P500 stocks (see GitHub).

Having successfully led, coached, and mentored the 'aNCA' package team of 7 developers and on-boarded new clinical and pre-clinical colleagues, I've found my greatest impact comes from combining this strategic approach with team leadership. My vision is to apply this lifelong passion for optimization at a larger scale, leading teams to build the most efficient, automated, and impactful solutions possible.

I would like to explain why my current profile fits the Principal C&SP Methodology Lead role. My background is rooted in PK/PD and pharmacometrics, but my day-to-day work is not limited to PK data. I handle clinical data from many domains, including time-to-event, adverse events, laboratory, efficacy, dose, exposure, and safety data. This gives me a practical view of how reusable tools, standards, and automation need to work across functions rather than only inside one specialty.

- **Clinical programming methodology:** I have converted legacy SAS processes into reproducible R pipelines, automated ADPC, ADNCA, and ADPP dataset generation, and built tools used by clinical and pre-clinical scientists at scale.
- **SAS and R expertise:** I am comfortable in both SAS (BASE/MACRO/SQL) and R, and I understand when a regulated clinical programming workflow needs one stack, the other, or a controlled bridge between them.
- **Regulated delivery:** My work includes GxP software standards, testing, documentation, code review, QC, Pinnacle 21, health authority responses, electronic submission support, and careful handling of confidential or anonymised clinical data.

- **Leadership and adoption:** As Product Owner of 'aNCA', I led and mentored 7 developers, onboarded new users, managed a 15+ stakeholder network, and turned a manual workflow into a 90% automated process.
- **Innovation with control:** I scale AI-assisted coding workflows for issue creation, automated problem solving, and code review, while keeping engineering standards, traceability, and review discipline in place.

I am ready to apply this combination of SAS/R expertise, clinical data standards, tool development, and practical leadership to build methodology solutions that increase automation, quality, and consistency across clinical and statistical programming teams.

Sincerely

Valentin Legras

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